

PREPOSITION

What is a Preposition ?

Preposition is a word or phrase which connects or joins **nouns or pronouns** to the rest of the sentence.

The object of a preposition is the noun or pronoun that follows the preposition and completes the meaning of the prepositional phrase.

Example :-

- Some people are very good **at** mathematics. ('Mathematics' is the object of preposition 'at'.)
- They are talking **about** her. ('her' is the object of preposition 'about'.)

Prepositions can show :-

1. The place/position of something :

- I found a number of books lying **on** the table.
- The dog crawled **between** us and lay down **at** our feet.
- His flat was **over** the shop.

2. The time when something happens :

- Shortly **after** their marriage, they moved to Jaipur.
- The meeting is scheduled to start **at** 9:00 AM.
- She will be back **in** an hour.

3. The way in which something is done :

- We went **by** train.
- She went to school **on** foot.

Common Prepositions :

about, above, across, after, against, around, at, before, behind, below, beneath, beside, besides, between, beyond, by, down, during, except, for, from, in, inside, into, like, near, of, off, on, out, outside, over, since, through, throughout, till, to, toward, under, until, up, upon, with, without, according to, because of, by way of, in addition to, in front of, in place of, in regard to, in spite of, instead of, on account of, out of, etc.

Some prepositions are made up of more than one word

Examples :-

- They moved here **because of** the baby.
- We sat **next to** each other.
- The hotel is perched **on top of** a cliff.

Let us consider some **prepositions** and their usage -

1. IN and INTO :-

The preposition "**into**" generally means movement toward the inside of something.

Examples :-

- Ram walked **into** the elevator.
- The boy put the toy **into** the box.

"**In**" is used to describe the position or location of someone or something within a space or area.

- She is **in** the room.
- The toy is **in** the box.

Note :- "Into" is also used to show the change in state.

Examples :-

- Translate **into** English.
- Milk turns **into** butter on churning.
- The caterpillar turned **into** a lovely butterfly.

There are certain phrases also where "into" is used- **Look into, turn into, let into, break into & see into.**

2. ON and ONTO :-

The preposition “**onto**” generally means movement or placement onto a surface or location.

Examples :-

- He threw the bag **onto** the bed.

“On” is used to describe something/someone being on a surface.

Examples :-

- There is a bag **on** the table.

3. BESIDE and BESIDES :-

BESIDES :- The word “**besides**” has two usages.

FIRST USAGE :- It is used when adding a stronger reason in addition to the reasons already given.

Example :-

- I didn't go to the movie yesterday because I was feeling tired, **besides** I didn't have enough money.

SECOND USAGE :- In addition to someone or something else that you are mentioning.

Examples :-

- Who else was at the party yesterday, **besides** you and Ravi?
- What do you do when you are free, **besides** playing tennis?
- **Besides** teaching you are expected to focus on content development also.

BESIDE :- ‘Beside’ is a preposition meaning “**next to**”.

Examples :-

- Mr. Mehta took a spoon and placed it **beside** his plate.
- She sat **beside** her best friend during the movie.

4. ON/OVER/ABOVE :-

“On” means that one thing is placed on the surface of something else. There is a contact between the surfaces.

Examples :-

- Most people put butter **on** their toast.
- Put your jacket **on** before you go outside.
- I wear my grandmother's ring **on** my left ring finger.

For body parts ‘on’ is used.

Examples :-

- The cap is **on** his head.
- The watch is **on** the wrist.
- He patted me **on** the shoulder.

‘Over’ means that one thing is covering or laying on the top of something else.

The definition is very similar to “On”. “On” is often used in place of “over” when it means “on top of.” i.e having **physical contact** but in case of “Over” there may or may not be **any physical contact**.

“Over” also suggests movement or covering a larger area, such as driving over a bridge.

Examples :-

- She is wearing a sundress **over** her swimsuit.
- We flew **over** the Taj Mahal. (Over would suggest movement from one side to the other.)
- Lay the blanket **over** his legs.
- I put my hand **over** her mouth to keep her quiet.

Note :- “Over” is also used to express ideas such as “older than” and “more than”.

Examples :-

- The company has been in business for **over** a century.

‘Above’ :- Above is usually something that is higher than something else. It also usually specifies a certain position.

Examples :-

- The kite rose **above** the clouds.
- His expenses are **above** five thousand rupees per month.
- A president is **above** a vice-president. (The president outranks the vice-president. He is higher than the vice-president.)

Note :- “Above” is used in **measurements** of temperature and height.

5. UNDER and BELOW :-

“Below” is preferred when one thing is not directly under another.

Examples :-

- The sun disappeared **below** the horizon. (NOT The sun disappeared under the horizon.)
- The climbers stopped several hundred meters **below** the top of the mountain.

In measurements of temperature and height we use below.

Examples :-

- The temperature is five degrees **below** zero.
- Parts of the city are **below** sea level.

“Under” is preferred when something is covered by what is over it.

Examples :-

- He was wearing a blue shirt **under** his sweater.
- The cat is **under** the bed.
- The whole village was **under** water.

To mean “less than” or “younger than” we use “under”.

Examples :-

- There were **under** ten students in the class.
(NOT - There were below ten students in the class.)
- You can't get a driving license if you are **under** 18.
(NOT - You can't get a driving license if you are below 18.)

6. UNDERNEATH and BENEATH :-

“Underneath” is preferred when something is hidden or covered.

Examples :-

- The dead body is underneath the shroud.

“Beneath” is preferred to show the level.

Examples :-

- A girl never marries anyone beneath her.

7. BETWEEN and AMONG :-

When exactly two entities are specified, “between” should be used.

- The debate is **between** the two candidates.

However, when more than two entities are involved or when the number of entities is unspecified, the word choice depends on what you want to say. “Between” should be used where the relationship is distinctly one-to-one:

- The agreement was entered into **between** the Seller, the Purchaser, and the Guarantor.

“**Among**” should be used where the entities are considered as a group, mass or collectivity. In case of more than two entities, among is used.

- There is consensus **among** the members of the jury.

More examples :-

- I have to discuss it **among** all five of us.
- Lata has been my favorite **among** all the singers.
- Lata has been my favorite **between** both the sisters.
- There is a wide difference of opinion **among** teachers regarding the grading system in schools.

8. AMID and AMIDST :-

‘**Amid and amidst**’ are used in case of uncountable nouns. Both ‘amid’ and ‘amidst’ mean in the middle of something or surrounded by something. Amid is used before words having a consonant sound and amidst is used before words having a vowel sound.

Examples :-

- My cell phone rang, **amidst** all the confusion of collecting and distributing the papers during the exam.
- She could see nothing **amid** snow and darkness so driving was very tough.
- The principal became emotional **amidst** enthusiastic farewells from all classes.

9. FOR and SINCE :-

‘**For**’: When we measure the duration – when we say how long something lasts.

For + a period of time

- I have known her **for** a long time.
- I have lived here **for** ten years.

‘**Since**’: ‘**Since**’ gives the starting point of actions or events. It refers to when things began.

Since + a point in time (in the past), until now.

- I’ve been waiting **since** 7 o’clock.
- I have known him **since** January.

‘**Since**’ is also used for giving a reason.

- **Since** I was unwell, I took a day off from work.

Note :- We can not use ‘as/since/because’ with ‘thus/so/therefore’.

- **Since** I have lost my job, so I can’t clear the loan. (**Incorrect**)
- **Since** I have lost my job, I can’t clear the loan. (**Correct**)

10. FOR ALL vs WITH :-

‘For all’ and ‘with’ both have the same meaning as despite. But in the case of sentence improvement/ fill in the blank, use “with”.

Examples :-

- With all her good features, the boy called her an ugly woman.
- For all her qualifications, she's still useless at the job.

11. ACROSS and THROUGH :-

‘**Across**’ means from one end to the other over a surface.

‘**Through**’ means from one end to the other end inside of something. E.g-tunnel

‘**Through**’ generally indicates transit from one end of something to another (often, but not always, the opposite end). This can involve a passage through space or time.

Examples :-

- We drove **through** the desert.
- I waited **through** the night.

‘**Through**’ can also mean to experience something when referring to experiences of life.

Examples :-

- He swam **across** the Ganga.
- The train went **through** the tunnel.
- They run a ferry service **across** the river.
- Blood circulates **through** the body.
- I went **through** a lot of hardships when I was unemployed.
- I need to go **through** a complete health check-up after the heart attack.
- It rained all **through** the afternoon.
- The dog kept barking all **through** the night.

Some other usage of 'Across'

- The shop is located just **across** the street. (On the other side)
- On my way to the office, I came **across** an old friend. (To meet by chance)

12. 'On-time' and 'In time' :-

'In time' means before the deadline.

- I had submitted the project report well **in time**.

'On time': at the planned time; neither late nor early

It means that the task was accomplished "exactly on schedule time".

- The train arrived **on time**.

'In time'- with enough time to spare; before the last moment.

- He would have died if they hadn't got him to the hospital **in time**.

13. 'At a time' and 'At times' :-

At a time - to do something separately.

- We should do one thing at a time.

At times - sometimes

- He is at times funny and humorous.

14. 'In the end' and 'at the end' :-

'In the end' - finally, after a long time

- **In the end**, I got a visa for Russia.
- **In the end**, we managed to shift to our own house.

'At the end' - at the point where something stops.

- I think the film's a bit boring **at the end**.
- The novel became interesting **at the end**.

15. Before :-

As a preposition "**before**" means earlier than.

- Divya had tea **before** coming to the class.
- Ahana was working as a teacher **before** she cleared this exam.

"**Before**" can also mean "**in the presence of**".

- He was brought **before** a judge.

Comparison: Before and in front of

Before usually refers to time and "in front of" usually refers to place.

- There is a school **in front of** my house. (**NOT** There is a school **before** my house.)
- I must reach there **before** nine o'clock. (**NOT** I must reach there **in front of** nine o'clock.)

Both "before" and "in front of" can be used to talk about the order in which people or things come in queues, lists etc.

- Do you mind? I was **before/in front of** you in the queue.

16. At :-**A. Used to point out specific time:**

- I will meet you **at** 12 p.m.
- The bus will stop here **at** 5:45 p.m.

B. Used to indicate a place:

- There is a party **at** the clubhouse.
- There were hundreds of people **at** the park.
- We saw a baseball game **at** the stadium.

C. Used to indicate an activity:

- He laughed **at** my acting.
- I am good **at** drawing portraits.

D. Used for exact addresses (addresses with a house or building number).

- Her favorite ice cream shop is **at** 27, Main Street.
- The seminar will be held **at** room no 35, Hyatt Hotel.

Note :- Do not use at for addresses without house or building numbers

- He lives **at** Gurudwara Road. (**Incorrect**)
- The office is **at** Main Street. (**Incorrect**)

Do not use at for general locations that have boundaries (cities, countries, regions, states, etc.)

17. In :-**A. Used for unspecific times during a day, month, season, year-**

- She always reads newspapers **in** the morning.
- **In** the summer, we have a rainy season for three weeks.
- The new semester will start **in** March.

B. Used to indicate a shape, color, or size:

- This painting is mostly **in** blue.
- The students stood **in** a circle.
- This jacket comes **in** four different sizes.

C. Used to indicate a belief, opinion, interest, or feeling:

- I believe **in** the next life.
- We are not interested **in** gambling.

18. By :-**A. Used to indicate proximity:**

- Can I sit **by** you?
- He was standing **by** me.
- The post office is **by** the bank.

B. Used to indicate the person that does something in a passive voice sentence:/

- The microwave was fixed **by** the mechanic.
- The flowers were delivered **by** a postman.
- The branch office was closed **by** the head office.

C. Used to indicate an action with a particular purpose:

- You can pass the exam **by** preparing for it.
- I expressed my feelings toward her **by** writing a letter.
- She finally broke the record **by** pure effort.

D. Used to indicate a mean or method:

- Please send this package to Russia **by** airmail.
- I came here **by** subway.

E. Mode of transportation takes preposition 'by' when it comes with go/come/arrive etc.

- We will go there **by** car.

19. With :-

A. Used to indicate being together or being involved:

- I ordered a sandwich **with** a drink.
- He was **with** his friend when he saw me.
- She has been working **with** her sister at the nail shop.
- The manager will be **with** you shortly.

B. Used to indicate "having":

- I met a guy **with** green eyes.
- Were you the one talking **with** an accent?
- People **with** a lot of money are not always happy.

C. Used to indicate "using":

- I wrote a letter **with** the pen you gave me.
- This is the soup that I made **with** rice and barley.
- He cut my hair **with** his scissors.

D. Used to indicate feeling:

- I am emailing you **with** my sincere apology.
- He came to the front stage **with** confidence.

E. Used to indicate agreement or understanding:

- Are you **with** me?
- Yes, I am completely **with** you.
- She agrees **with** me.

20. NOTWITHSTANDING/ IN SPITE OF and DESPITE :-

They can be used interchangeably. Do not use 'of' with despite.

- **In spite of** his criminal record he got the job.
- Our company is doing extremely well **despite** the recession.
- He was very fast **in spite of** being terribly overweight.
- **Despite** the heavy rain, we managed to reach the venue in time.
- **Despite** being much younger than the others, he won the race.
- **Notwithstanding** your support, she was not able to get success.

21. TILL and UNTIL :-

'Until' is used for a point of time. 'Until' and 'till' can be used interchangeably in this case.

- The farmers will not sow any crops **until** it rains.
- I will not issue you a new book **until** you return the old one.

'Till' can also be used for a point in the distance when that is not the destination. Here, 'upto' can also be used.

- I went **up to/till** the crossroads only as there was a heavy traffic jam on the main road.

22. DURING and WHILE :-

'During' is a preposition which is used before a noun (during + noun) to say when something happens. It does not tell us how long it happened.

Example :-

- Nobody spoke **during** the presentation.
- There was plenty of snowfall **during** the winter.
- I got hurt **during** the match.
- He fell asleep **during** the meeting.

'While' is used with a subject and a verb (**while + subject + verb**).

Example :-

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- The phone rang **while** I was watching TV.
- I met him **while** we were studying in the library.
- **While** he was riding the horse, he fell.
- **While** I was bathing, I slipped on the wet floor.

23. ALONG :-

A. From one end to or towards the other end of something.

- They walked slowly **along** the road.
- I looked **along** the shelves for the book I needed.

B. In a line that follows the side of something long.

- Houses had been built **along** both sides of the river.
- Rose plants were planted **along** the road.

C. At a particular point on or beside something long.

- You'll find his office just **along** the corridor.

24. OFF :-

'Off' indicates separation from a place. It means moving away from a place /an object OR taking something away from a surface.

We speak of getting on a bus and off a bus, taking things off the table and putting them on the floor.

Examples of other common usages of "off" as a preposition:

- Did she jump **off** or fall **off** the mountain or did someone push her **off**? Nobody knows!
- There's 20 % **off** on all CDs at the music shop in Rajguru market next Friday. (**Here, 'off' has been used to show discount on an item**)
- Keep **off** the grass in this park.

Time that is taken off work or off school typically because of illness, tiredness or holiday arrangements.

- We're getting two extra days **off** school at the beginning of June for the Silver Jubilee of the school.
- I shall have to take a day **off** from work and meet a doctor.
- Why don't you take a half-day **off** today ?

Expression with 'off'

- **Off-balance, off-colour, off-duty, off days**

Phrasal verbs with 'off'

There are many common phrasal verbs with 'off'

such as **put off** (postpone), **knock off** (finish work), **lay off** (dismiss from work, usually temporarily), **bring something off** (complete something successfully).

- I've been **putting it off** for weeks, but it's no good, I shall have to go to the dentist soon.
- 700 workers will be **laid off** in the factory following a decline in orders.

25. But/But for :-

But: Except

But for: without

Example :-

- But for your support he would have died.
- He is nothing but nonsense.

26. To/Towards :-

To : destination

Towards : direction

Example :-

- I am going to a temple to pray.
- Are you coming towards our home town?

27. IN/AFTER :-

In + period of time shows future time.

After + point of time shows any time.

Example :-

- He will be back **in** two days.
- He will meet me **after** Monday.

28. Prepositions are used in the following way with the verb of motion.

Verb of motion: go, come, arrive, return, reach, get, walk, run etc.

Verb of motion + no preposition + no determiner + Home.

Verb of motion + appropriate preposition + determiner + Home.

Any other verb + preposition +(determiner) + Home.

Example :-

- We are getting late so let's **go home**.
- Why are you **going to her home**?

RULES OF PREPOSITIONS :-

RULE 1 :-

Made from/ Made of:

Made of: when the original material can be taken back

Made from: when the original material can't be taken back.

Example :-

- Burfi is **made from** Khoya. (**Correct:** khoya can't be taken back from burfi, so 'made from' has been used).
- That chair is **made of** glass. (**Correct:** as we get the glass from the chair).

RULE 2 :- Differ from / Differ with / Differ on:

Differ from : in case of colour/size/quality.

Differ with : in case of opinions.

Differ on : point.

Example :-

- Your state **differs from** mine in many ways.
- I always **differ with** my mother-in-law.
- They **differ on** their views regarding climate change.

RULE 3 :- Agree with / Agree to / Agree on:

Agree with: used for persons

Agree to: any proposal or request

Agree on: for any point.

Example :-

- Why don't you agree **with** your parents?
- No one will agree **to** your proposal.
- It is very difficult for me to agree **on** this point.

RULE 4 :- By/With/In

With: in case of tools or instruments

By: In case of doers.

Example :-

- The photograph was taken **by** me.
- The photograph was taken **with** the camera.

In ink/pencil: for material used for writing or drawing

With a pen/ pencil: for the means or tool used for writing or drawing

Example :-

- I am in the habit of writing the letter **in** pencil.
- He signed the contract **with** a pen to make sure the signature was permanent.
- The artist sketched the intricate design **in** ink.

RULE 5 :- Taste in/Taste for**Taste in:** For judgment or assessment.**Taste for:** For liking or preference.**Example :-**

- You can't be a musician because you have no **taste in** music.
- He has a **taste for** chocolate desserts, often indulging in rich cakes and creamy mousses.

RULE 6 :- Tired of/Tired from:**Tired of:** to be bored (or annoyed from) of a person or an activity when you have been doing it for a long time**Tired from:** Physical or mental fatigue/exhaustion resulting from doing something. It means the person needs to take rest.**Example :-**

- The children are **tired from** moving here and there in the field.(fatigue from physical activity)
- Today, the youth are **tired of** unemployment.(annoyed from unemployment)

RULE 7 :-**Absorbed/Engrossed/Soaked in:** to get so lost in an activity that you do not pay attention to anything else around you.**Soaked with:** saturated with a liquid.**Example :-**

- Payal is absorbed **in** her work.
- My clothes are soaked **with** oil.

RULE 8 :-**Part from** - In case of a person**Part with** - In case of wealth or possessions**Part company with** - to end a relationship**Partake of** - to eat or drink**Partake in** - to participate**Example :-**

- It was very difficult for me to part from him.
- A miser can never part with his wealth.
- I want to partake in the annual function.
- He was very happy to partake of this breakfast.

RULE 9 :- As/Like**As:** in the form/role of**Like:** resemblance or similarity**Like:** for example**Example :-**

- Sapna was swimming **like** a fish. (not as)
- I am your sister and **as** a sister I care for you.

RULE 10 :- If the following words are used in an active voice, do not use a preposition with them.**Marry, Stress, emphasize, ridicule, control, demand, order, describe, order, tell, attack, resemble, succeed, invade, enter, befall, join, affect, board, ensure, sign, direct, eschew, stress, investigate, accompany, violate, precede, consider, emphasize and comprise.****Examples :-**

- Ram married **with** Sita.
(**Incorrect**- The sentence is in active voice, so remove "with")
- Ram married Sita.(**Correct**)
- Ram is married **to** Sita (**Correct- Passive voice**)
- He signed on the paper. (**Incorrect**)
- He signed the paper. (**Correct**)

RULE 11 :-When a **noun is qualified** by an '**infinitive**', then the **preposition is used after the 'infinitive**.**Examples :-**

- Divya gave me a pen to **write with**.

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- This picture is beautiful to **look at**.

RULE 12 :-**Prepositions in Parallel -Form:**

When two **words/verbs/adjectives**, etc. require different prepositions, we must use **appropriate prepositions with both of them**.

Examples :-

- I was **surprised at** as well as **disgusted with** his behaviour.
- His car is **different from** and **cheaper than** mine.

Note :- When two words or phrases are used in parallel and require the same preposition to be idiomatically correct, the **preposition** does not have to be used twice.

Example :-

- You can wear that outfit in summer and in winter. (**Remove "in" before "winter"**)

RULE 13 :-

We should not use preposition '**into**' with '**enter**' if it indicates **entering physical spaces**, but in case of any **agreement** we have to use '**into**' after '**enter**'.

Examples :-

- Ahana **entered** the Railway Station.
- We **entered into** an agreement with the media house.

RULE 14 :-

No Preposition is used with the following. **Downstairs/today/tomorrow/yesterday/downtown/the following day/the next day/inside/this morning /afternoon/outside/upstairs/ uptown.**

Examples :-

- He went upstairs.
- He went home.
- They both went outside.

RULE 15 :-

Preposition '**to**' is not used with the following verbs when they are used in communication and before the object of the sentence.

Verbs- 'order, thank, welcome, tell, advise, ask, request, command, forbid, encourage, inform, warm, congratulate, remind.

Examples :-

- The principal ordered **to** the peon to finish his work. (**remove 'to'**)
- They requested **to** me to play well for winning the match. (**remove 'to'**)

RULE 16 :-**Prepositions with Nouns, Adjectives, and Verbs.****(i) Noun + Preposition :**

approval of; awareness of; belief in; concern for; confusion about; desire for; fondness for; grasp of; hatred of; hope for; interest in; love of; need for; participation in; reason for; respect for; success in; understanding of

(ii) Adjective + Preposition :

afraid of; angry at; aware of; capable of; careless about; familiar with; fond of; happy about; interested in; jealous of; made of; married to; proud of; similar to; sorry for; sure of; tired of; worried about.

(iii) Verb + Preposition :

apologize for; ask about; ask for; belong to; bring up; care for; find out; give up; grow up; look for; look forward to; look up; make up; pay for; prepare for; study for; talk about; think about; trust in; work for; worry about.

RULE 17 :-

When the '**object**' of the preposition is an Interrogative Pronoun '**What, Who, Whom, Which, Where etc.**', the preposition usually takes the '**end**' or '**front**' position.

Examples :-

- Whom are you **talking to**?
- What are you **looking for**?

RULE 18 :-

When the 'object' of the **preposition** is a **relative Pronoun 'that'**, the preposition takes the 'end' position.

Examples :-

- This is the book **that** she is looking **for**.
- Here is the file **that** you asked **for**.

A LIST OF FIXED PREPOSITIONS (Prepositions most frequently used with verbs, nouns, adjectives)

- | | |
|--|---|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • <u>Abhorrent to (a person)</u>
E.g. - The idea of lying is abhorrent to me. • <u>Abide by (a rule, a decision)</u>
E.g. - We must all abide by the judge's decision. • <u>Abide in (a place)</u>
E.g. - He chose to abide in a small cottage by the lake. • <u>Abide with (a person)</u>
E.g. - She asked if I could abide with her for a few days. • <u>Ability at (to indicate someone's skill)</u>
E.g. - He has a remarkable ability at solving puzzles. • <u>Able to</u>
E.g. - She is able to complete the project on time. • <u>Admit of (a solution or to allow)</u>
E.g. - The complex problem admits of no easy solution. • <u>Abound in / with (to be filled)</u>
E.g. - The garden abounds in beautiful flowers. • <u>Admit to (a crime, confess)</u>
He admitted to the crime when questioned by the police. • <u>Absolve from/of (a person from duty or punishment)</u>
The priest absolved him of his sins. • <u>Abstain from (doing something)</u>
She decided to abstain from alcohol for a month. • <u>Abundant in / with (to be filled)</u>
The forest is abundant with wildlife. • <u>Accede to (a demand)</u>
The company acceded to the demands of the union. • <u>Accepted by (a person)</u>
The proposal was accepted by the committee. • <u>Accommodate to (a situation)</u>
We need to accommodate to the new regulations. • <u>Accompanied with (a thing)</u>
The dish was accompanied with a side of vegetables. • <u>Afraid of</u>
She is afraid of spiders. • <u>Accountable to (a person)/for (something)</u>
The manager is accountable to the board for the company's performance. • <u>Accused of (charged with offence)</u>
He was accused of theft by the authorities. • <u>Accustomed to</u> | <p>She is accustomed to the cold weather in her hometown.</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • <u>Acquit of (crime, blame)</u>
The jury acquitted him of all charges. • <u>Adamant about (doing something)</u>
She is adamant about finishing her work on time. • <u>Adapted for (purpose, nature)</u>
This software is adapted for use in schools. • <u>Addicted to</u>
He is addicted to video games. • <u>Allocate to</u>
Resources were allocated to the new project. • <u>Amazed at (non-living things)</u>
He was amazed at the tricks of the magician. • <u>Amazed by (a person)</u>
The audience was amazed by the funambulist. • <u>Ambitious for / of (indicate desire/goal)</u>
He is ambitious for success in his career. • <u>Ambivalent about</u>
She feels ambivalent about moving to a new city. • <u>Amenable to (controlled or affected by)</u>
He is amenable to reason. • <u>Amused at/by/with (entertained or interested)</u>
She was amused by the comedian's jokes. • <u>Angry about / against / at / over / towards (a thing)</u>
He was angry about the delay. • <u>Angry against / at / towards / with (a person)</u>
She was angry with her brother. • <u>Annoyed at/about (something)</u>
He was annoyed at the noise outside. • <u>Annoyed with (a person)</u>
She was annoyed with her colleague. • <u>Answer to</u>
He had to answer to his boss. • <u>Answer for (misdeeds)</u>
He had to answer for his actions. • <u>Antagonistic to / towards</u>
He felt antagonistic towards the new policy. • <u>Antipathy to / toward(s)</u>
She felt a strong antipathy towards him. • <u>Antithesis between (contrast)</u> |
|--|---|

There is an antithesis between good and evil.

- **Antithesis of (opposite)**
His actions were the antithesis of his words.
- **Antithetical to**
His views are antithetical to mine.
- **Anxious about / for (health, safety)**
She is anxious about her exam results.
- **Blind in (to lose an eye)**
He is blind in one eye.
- **Blind to (to be ignorant)**
She is blind to the risks involved.
- **Borrow (a thing) from (someone)**
Can I borrow a pen from you?
- **Bound for (destination)**
The ship is bound for New York.
- **Boycott of (to refuse)**
There was a boycott of the new policy.
- **Brag about / of (sense of boasting, not praising)**
He likes to brag about his accomplishments.
- **Breach in (for security or data privacy)**
There was a breach in the company's security system.
- **Breach of (trust, rules)**
His actions were a breach of trust.
- **Brunt of (something harmful or dangerous)**
She bore the brunt of the criticism.
- **Base on**
The movie is based on a true story.
- **Battle against**
They are battling against corruption.
- **Begin by (doing something)**
Let's begin by introducing ourselves.
- **Begin from (a point)**
The discussion began from a simple question.
- **Begin with (an act)**
We will begin with a short video.
- **Belief in**
She has a strong belief in justice.
- **Belong to (be a member)**
This book belongs to me.
- **Belong with (same category)**
These two items belong with the others.
- **Beneficial for / to**
Regular exercise is beneficial to your health.
- **Benefit of (the benefactor)**
He saw the benefit of a good education.
- **Benefit to (the beneficiary)**
The new policy will be a benefit to everyone.
- **Benefit from**
She benefited from the training program.

- **Bestow on / upon**
The king bestowed honors upon the brave soldiers.
- **Bereft of (deprived)**
He felt bereft of hope after losing all his money in the stock market.
- **Campaign against / for**
They launched a campaign against pollution.
- **Capable of**
She is capable of great things.
- **Capacity for (aptitude for)**
He has a capacity for learning multiple languages.
- **Capacity of (containing)**
The stadium has a capacity of 50,000 people.
- **Careless about / of / with**
He is careless with his belongings.
- **Cause for / of**
The cause of the accident is still unknown.
- **Central to**
Education is central to economic development.
- **Certain about / of**
She is certain of her decision.
- **Champion of (supporter of)**
He is a champion of human rights.
- **Chance of (to indicate possibility)**
There is a chance of rain tomorrow.
- **Chance to (win or not)**
He had a chance to win the game.
- **Chance on (to show coincidence)**
I chanced on an old friend in the city.
- **Characteristic for / of**
Punctuality is characteristic of her.
- **Charged with (a crime, task)**
 - (i) He was charged with organizing the party. (task)
 - (ii) The suspect was charged with theft after being caught on camera stealing merchandise from the store. (crime)
- **Compare to (comparison of different things)**
He compared her smile to the sun.
- **Compare with (comparison of same things)**
The new model doesn't compare with the old one.
- **Deal in (doing business)**
He deals in antique furniture.
- **Deal out (to distribute)**
He dealt out the cards to the players.
- **Deal with (attend to)**
She had to deal with a lot of issues at work.
- **Debar from**
He was debarred from practicing law.
- **Decide about (considering a particular matter)**

They will decide about the location tomorrow.

- **Decide on (considering from alternatives)**

She decided on the blue dress after trying several dresses.

- **Decide to (to take action)**

They decided to go on a trip.

- **Defence against (a threat/danger)**

The fortress was built as a defence against invaders.

- **Defence for (excuse, justification)**

He had no defence for his thoughtless actions.

- **Defence of (to support a particular idea)**

She spoke in defence of free speech.

- **Defend against/from (to indicate resistance from a danger)**

They defended the town against the attack.

- **Defer to (a person, opinion)**

She always defers to her elders.

- **Defiant against, of, to, toward(s)**

He was defiant against authority.

- **Deficient in**

The diet is deficient in vitamins.

- **Definition of (a word)**

What is the definition of "resilience"?

- **Demand on (a person)/ for (something)**

The manager placed a high demand on us for increased productivity during the busy season.

- **Demand of (a person)**

The professor had a significant demand of his students to complete the project within two weeks.

- **Demand (a tangible thing) from (a person)**

The landlord demanded the overdue rent payment from the tenant.

- **Demanding on (onerous)**

The work is very demanding on my energy.

- **Effect on**

The new law will have a positive effect on the economy.

- **Embark for (a place)**

They will embark for Paris on their summer vacation next week.

- **Embark on (a ship, career)**

(i) She decided to embark on a career in medicine.

(ii) The passengers eagerly embarked on the cruise ship for their Caribbean adventure.

- **Embarrassed by**

He was embarrassed by his mistake.

- **Embarrassed with**

She was embarrassed with the attention she received.

- **Embroiled in (a dispute or complex situation)**

They became embroiled in a legal battle.

- **Embroiled with (a person)**

He was embroiled with his business partner.

- **Empathize with**

She can empathize with his situation.

- **Empathy with**

He showed empathy with the victims.

- **Employee of (a company)**

He is an employee of a multinational corporation.

- **Enchanted by/with**

She was enchanted by the beautiful scenery.

- **End to (a problem)**

They worked to bring an end to the conflict.

- **End at (a place)**

The road ends at the river.

- **End in / with**

The play ended with a dramatic scene.

- **Endowed by (fate) with (talent)**

He was endowed by nature with great intelligence.

- **Enemy of / to**

He is an enemy of the state.

- **Engrossed in (being deeply focused)**

She was engrossed in her book.

- **Engulfed by (state of being overtaken)**

The city was engulfed by flames.

- **Engulfed in (state of being enveloped/absorbed)**

He was engulfed in his work.

- **Enough of**

I've had enough of your excuses.

- **Favourable for (suitable)**

The weather was favourable for a picnic.

- **Favourable to (in favour of)**

The judge's ruling was favourable to the defendant.

- **Fear about / of (to express anxiety)**

She expressed fear about the future.

- **Fear for (one's safety)**

He feared for his family's safety.

- **Fear of (to specify the event causing anxiety)**

He has a fear of heights.

- **Fight about / over (things, opinions)**

They had a fight about the best way to solve the problem.

- **Fight against (a disease or problem)**

He is fighting against cancer.

- **Fight for (advocating a particular belief or cause)**

They are fighting for equal rights.

- **Fight with (a person, not against)**

She had a fight with her brother.

- **Filled by (indicate occupying a particular position)**

The position was filled by an experienced candidate.

- **Filled with (contents)**
The jar was filled with cookies.
- **Familiar to (known or recognized)**
The face was familiar to him.
- **Familiar with (to have knowledge)**
She is familiar with the new software.
- **Fascinated by / for / with**
He is fascinated by ancient history.
- **Fascination for / of (a thing)**
She has a fascination for astronomy.
- **Fatal for / to**
The disease was fatal to the elderly.
- **Father by (to indicate biological father)**
He is the father by her first marriage.
- **Father with (to describe father in various situations)**
He was a strict father with his children.
- **Generous in / of / to / with**
He was generous with his time.
- **Given to (habitual)**
He is given to daydreaming.
- **Glad at (an event)**
She was glad at the news of her promotion.
- **Glad of (assistance)**
He was glad of her help.
- **Glad for (a person)**
She was glad for her friend when she got a salary hike.
- **Graduate (noun) of (to specify institution)**
She is a graduate of Harvard University.
- **Graduate (verb) from (to specify institution)**
He graduated from Stanford University.
- **Grapple with**
They had to grapple with a difficult problem.
- **Grateful for (something)**
She was grateful for the opportunity.
- **Grateful to (somebody)**
He was grateful to his mentor.
- **Greedy for**
He was greedy for more power.
- **Grieve about / at / for / over (to express sorrow or sadness)**
She grieved over the loss of her pet.
- **Grieve for (sorrow for someone)**
He grieved for his deceased friend.
- **Guard against (to prevent something undesirable from happening)**
They installed cameras to guard against theft.
- **Guard from (protection from a specific threat)**
She guarded the children from danger.
- **Guilty about (feeling of remorse)**
He felt guilty about lying to his friend.
- **Habituated to**
He is habituated to waking up early.
- **Handling of (in case of managing various situations)**
The handling of the crisis was commendable.
- **Hanker after / for**
She hankered for a simpler life.
- **Happen to (somebody)**
What happened to your car?
- **Harmful to**
Smoking is harmful to your health.
- **Hate for / of**
He has a strong hate for injustice.
- **Hateful to**
His actions were hateful to many.
- **Hatred for / of**
She felt a deep hatred for the oppressors.
- **Hats off to (someone) / for (something)**
Hats off to you for completing the marathon!
- **Hazardous to (one's health)**
This substance is hazardous to your health.
- **Heart-broken at**
She was heart-broken at the news of his departure.
- **Heed of**
The hikers took heed of the weather warnings and postponed their trip.
- **Heedful of**
Be heedful of the consequences.
- **Heedless of**
He was heedless of the risks involved.
- **Heir to (property, throne)**
He is the heir to the throne.
- **Impressed by / with**
She was impressed by his knowledge.
- **Inadequate for (a person)**
The training was inadequate for the new hires.
- **Inadequate to (one's needs)**
The resources were inadequate to meet the demands.
- **Incapable of (doing)**
He is incapable of lying.
- **Include among (two or more)**
She was included among the top performers.
- **Include in (contained within a category)**
This feature is included in the new update.
- **Incomprehension of (to denote inability)**
His incomprehension of the subject was evident.
- **Inconsiderate about (things or opinions)**
He is inconsiderate about other people's time.
- **Inconsiderate of (someone's feelings)**

She was inconsiderate of his feelings.

- **Increase in (energy)**

There was an increase in energy consumption.

- **Inculcate (an idea) in / into (someone)**

They tried to inculcate good values in their children.

- **Indebted to (you)/ for (assistance)**

I am indebted to you for your help.

- **Independent of (not from or on)**

She is financially independent of her parents.

- **Indicative of**

The results are indicative of a larger problem.

- **Indifferent to**

She was indifferent to the outcome of the game, as she didn't support either team.

- **Jealous for / of (reputation)**

She is jealous of her friend's success.

- **Join in (a game)**

Do you want to join in the game?

- **Join to (connect)**

The bridge joins the two cities.

- **Join with (a person or thing)**

He joined with his friends for the project.

- **Jubilant about (good news)**

They were jubilant about their victory.

- **Judged by**

He was judged by his peers for his poor choice of clothing.

- **Justification for**

There is no justification for his actions.

- **Justified in (opinions)**

She felt justified in her decision.

- **Keen of (hearing)**

The dog, keen of hearing, detected the intruder long before anyone else.

- **Keen on (enthusiastic)**

She is keen on learning new languages.

- **Knowledge of (a subject, not about)**

He has extensive knowledge of history.

- **Knowledgeable about**

She is knowledgeable about computer science.

- **Labour at (a task)**

He laboured at his desk all night.

- **Labour for (a person, an end)**

(i) They laboured for a better future.

(ii) The workers laboured for their demanding boss from dawn till dusk.

- **Labour in (a cause)**

She laboured in the field of education.

- **Labour under (a disadvantage, difficulty)**

He laboured under a heavy workload.

- **Lack of (money)**

There was a lack of resources.

- **Live by (to denote beliefs that someone adheres to)**

He lives by his principles.

- **Live for (fame)**

He dedicated his entire career to acting, living for the fame and recognition it brought him.

- **Live on (rely for sustenance)**

They live on a modest income.

- **Look forward to**

The children look forward to their summer vacation all year long.

- **Marked by**

The event was marked by a grand celebration.

- **Married to (a person)**

She is married to a doctor.

- **Married with (married and have children)**

They are married with two children.

- **Martyr for / in (a cause)**

He became a martyr for freedom.

- **Martyr to (a disease)**

She was a martyr to cancer.

- **Mastery of (an activity)**

He has mastery of several languages.

- **Mastery over (a rival)**

He gained mastery over his competitor.

- **Matter for (an expert)**

The complex legal issues in the case were a matter for an expert in international law.

- **Matter of (survival)**

In the harsh wilderness, finding clean water became a matter of survival.

- **Name after / for**

(i) They named the baby after her grandmother. (to give the same name)

(ii) The scientist earned a name for his groundbreaking research in renewable energy.

- **Name to (appoint)**

He was named to the board of directors.

- **Necessary for / to**

Good nutrition is necessary for health.

- **Necessity for / of (strict measures)**

There is a necessity for immediate action.

- **Need for / of**

There is a need for more volunteers.

- **Needed from (somebody)**

What is needed from me to complete the project?

- **Negligent in (duties)**

He was negligent in his responsibilities.

- **Negligent of (fame)**

She was negligent of her health.

- **Nervous about / around / of (strangers)**

He is nervous around strangers.

- **Object to**

She objects to the new policy.

- **Obsessed about / by / with**

He is obsessed with his work.

- **Obsession with**

Her obsession with perfection is exhausting.

- **Obstacle to**

The main obstacle to progress is lack of funds.

- **Offended at / by / with**

She was offended by his remarks.

- **Offensive to**

The comment was offensive to many people.

- **Open for (business)**

The store is open for business.

- **Open to (suggestions)**

She is open to new ideas.

- **Opinion about / on (a subject)**

What is your opinion on this issue?

- **Opinion of (a person)**

My opinion of the author shifted after reading more of her books and understanding her unique style.

- **Perpendicular to**

The wall is perpendicular to the floor.

- **Persevere in / with**

She persevered in her efforts despite the obstacles.

Practice Exercise

Spot the Error :-

Directions :- In these questions, read each sentence to find out whether there is any error in it. The error, if any, will be in one part of the sentence. The number of that part is the answer, if there is no error the answer is (d). (Ignore errors of punctuation, if any.)

Q.1. (a) She worked like/(b)a teacher for many /(c) years before retiring/(d) no error.

Q.2. (a) He was tired of/(b) working long hours /(c) at the construction site/(d) no error.

Q.3. (a) Her taste in clothing is /(b) impeccable; she always chooses /(c) outfits that are both elegant and fashionable/(d) no error.

Q.4. (a) He agreed with /(b) the terms of/(c) the contract./(d) no error.

Q.5. (a) The new model /(b)differs with the old one /(c)in terms of size and features/(d) no error.

Q.6. (a) They waited patiently/(b) from the guests /(c)to arrive home./(d) no error.

Q.7. (a) She got of the/(b) train at the /(c) next station./(d) no error.

Q.8. (a) She placed/(b) the book back /(c)on the shelf./(d) no error.

Q.9. (a) But your help, I wouldn't /(b) have been able to finish /(c)the project on time./(d) no error.

Q.10. (a) He looks /(b)as /(c) his father./(d) no error.

Q.11. (a) She's with us /(b)in our efforts to /(c)improve the community./(d) no error.

Q.12. (a) The new product /(b)will be launched /(c)for the next quarter./(d) no error.

Q.13. (a) We would have won /(b) the game, but for/(c) that last-minute mistake./(d) no error.

Q.14. (a) He's overwhelmed /(b) with sadness /(c) after the loss of his pet. /(d) no error.

Q.15. (a) She walked/(b) the store /(c)to buy groceries./(d) no error.

Q.16. (a) He painted /(b)the portrait /(c)from oil colors./(d) no error.

Q.17. (a) After months of /(b) disagreements, they decided to/(c)part company from their business partners./(d) no error.

Q.18. (a) We'll be /(b) traveling Europe/(c) in the summer/(d) no error.

- Q.19. (a) Everyone was / (b) happy with the / (c) outcome except for him. / (d) no error.
- Q.20. (a) He's interested / (b) to learning / (c) new languages. / (d) no error.
- Q.21. (a) He left for / (b) home early / (c) in the morning. / (d) no error.
- Q.22. (a) She walked towards / (b) the beach to / (c) enjoy the sunset. / (d) no error.
- Q.23. (a) The dress comes / (b) in various colors, / (c) including blue and red. / (d) no error.
- Q.24. (a) I differ to my colleague / (b) on the best approach / (c) to solving this problem / (d) no error.
- Q.25. (a) He enjoys outdoor / (b) activities as hiking, / (c) camping, and fishing. / (d) no error.
- Q.26. (a) She walked through / (b) the field to reach / (c) the other side. / (d) no error.
- Q.27. (a) He has a taste to spicy food, always / (b) adding extra chili to his dishes / (c) for an extra kick. / (d) no error.
- Q.28. (a) We must guard / (b) against making / (c) careless mistakes. / (d) no error.
- Q.29. (a) The committee finally / (b) agreed to a budget / (c) for the project. / (d) no error.
- Q.30. (a) It was hard for her to part with / (b) her best friend when she / (c) moved to another country. / (d) no error.
- Q.31. (a) She wore sunscreen / (b) to guard her skin / (c) for harmful UV rays. / (d) no error.
- Q.32. (a) Bread is / (b) made of / (c) wheat flour / (d) no error.
- Q.33. (a) He fixed the broken / (b) shelf with a / (c) hammer and nails. / (d) no error.
- Q.34. (a) He was reluctant / (b) to part for his vintage coin collection, but he needed the / (c) money for an emergency. / (d) no error.
- Q.35. (a) Their lack of money / (b) prevented them / (c) for taking a vacation. / (d) no error.
- Q.36. (a) She lives on the / (b) motto 'work hard, / (c) play hard.' / (d) no error.
- Q.37. (a) She read through / (b) the entire book / (c) in one sitting. / (d) no error.
- Q.38. (a) She was absorbed / (b) to her studies, spending / (c) hours at the library every day. / (d) no error.
- Q.39. (a) You should compare / (b) your progress to / (c) that of your peers. / (d) no error.
- Q.40. (a) He lives on the fame / (b) and recognition that / (c) comes with success. / (d) no error.
- Q.41. (a) The room is equipped / (b) in a television / (c) and a mini-fridge. / (d) no error.
- Q.42. (a) The members of / (b) the committee differ with / (c) the allocation of funds for the project. / (d) no error.
- Q.43. (a) After playing in the rain, the children / (b) were soaked in water, their / (c) clothes clinging to their bodies. / (d) no error.
- Q.44. (a) The accident / (b) was caused by / (c) reckless driving. / (d) no error.
- Q.45. (a) Guests were / (b) invited to partake in the delicious buffet / (c) at the wedding reception. / (d) no error.
- Q.46. (a) She stayed / (b) at home / (c) during the weekend. / (d) no error.
- Q.47. (a) She lives with her / (b) savings until she / (c) finds a new job. / (d) no error.
- Q.48. (a) Plastic bottles / (b) are made of / (c) recycled materials. / (d) no error.
- Q.49. (a) They were amused / (b) to the / (c) entertaining performance. / (d) no error.
- Q.50. (a) She eagerly volunteered / (b) to partake for the charity marathon to / (c) raise funds for cancer research. / (d) no error.

Q.51. (a) He was annoyed /(b)to his coworker for interrupting /(c)him during the meeting./(d) no error.

Q.52. (a) He persevered /(b)through difficult times/(c) to achieve success./(d) no error.

Q.53. (a) Paper is/(b) made from /(c)wood pulp./(d) no error.

Q.54. (a) She's capable /(b)for handling /(c)challenging situations./(d) no error.

Q.55. (a) She's tired from the /(b)constant noise in the /(c)city and longs for some peace/(d) no error.

Q.56. (a) She has a /(b)capacity of learning /(c)new languages./(d) no error.

Q.57. (a) She finally got/(b) a chance for meet her/(c) favorite author./(d) no error.

Q.58. (a) The painting /(b)was created /(c)by Picasso/(d) no error.

Q.59. (a) She agrees/(b) for her colleague's assessment /(c)of the situation./(d) no error.

Q.60. (a) She had to /(b)accommodate herself for the /(c)new work environment./(d) no error.

Q.61. (a) He's always /(b)with his family /(c)during the holidays./(d) no error.

Q.62. (a) The teacher dealt /(b)in worksheets /(c)to the students./(d) no error.

Q.63. (a) She's ambitious /(b)for a successful /(c)career in politics./(d) no error.

Q.64. (a) The teacher compared /(b)the student's /(c)essay with a work of art./(d) no error.

Q.65. (a) She became blind /(b) to her left eye /(c)due to an injury./(d) no error.

Q.66. (a) She returned /(b)home from /(c)her vacation./(d) no error.

Q.67. (a) The table/(b) is made /(c)from wood./(d) no error.

Q.68. (a) The committee/(b) decided with /(c) a new policy./(d) no error.

Q.69. (a) She was blind in/(b)the consequences/(c) of her actions./(d) no error.

Q.70. (a) They plan to visit/(b) their grandparents/(c) in December./(d) no error.

Fill in the Blanks with the Correct Preposition.

Directions :- Sentences are given with blanks to be filled in with an appropriate and suitable word. Four alternatives are suggested for each question. Choose the correct alternative out of the four.

Q.1. Nadheeka was musing _____ memories of the past.

- (a) over (b) about (c) on (d) from

Q.2. On my return from a long holiday, I had to _____ with a lot of work.

- (a) catch on (b) catch up (c) make up (d) take up

Q.3. We must avail ourselves _____ every opportunity that comes in our way.

- (a) of (b) on (c) against (d) to

Q.4. He held _____ passionately.

- (a) on (b) in (c) off (d) away

Q.5. The teacher gives many examples to _____ the idea contained in the poem.

- (a) bring about (b) bring in (c) bring forth (d) bring out

Q.6. She stood _____ the crowd, quite amazed.

- (a) in (b) within (c) among (d) into

- Q.7.** He is indifferent alike _____ praise and blame.
(a) in (b) to (c) for (d) about
- Q.8.** King George V's accession _____ the throne was celebrated with great pomp.
(a) for (b) with (c) against (d) to
- Q.9.** We are all very indignant _____ the injustice done to him.
(a) for (b) of (c) to (d) at
- Q.10.** Mr. Obi put his whole life _____ the work.
(a) on (b) in (c) into (d) upon
- Q.11.** She is beautiful _____ brave.
(a) but (b) and (c) yet (d) so
- Q.12.** Gandhiji will _____ in history as one of the greatest men, that ever lived.
(a) go by (b) go on (c) go down (d) to through
- Q.13.** Today students should be reconciled _____ the way things are changing.
(a) with (b) to (c) for (d) at
- Q.14.** The meeting is _____ because the funds have not arrived.
(a) put in (b) put off (c) put away (d) put out
- Q.15.** It took the child a long time to recover _____ the shock.
(a) under (b) from (c) over (d) about
- Q.16.** At great length, that night they _____ the feasibility of their plans.
(a) discussed about (b) discussed (c) discussed regarding (d) discussed on
- Q.17.** They have had to put _____ the football match because of snow.
(a) of (b) off (c) up (d) on
- Q.18.** I complimented him _____ his success in the examination.
(a) at (b) on (c) about (d) for
- Q.19.** The dramatist must cater _____ the taste of the audience.
(a) to (b) over (c) into (d) for
- Q.20.** Suitable steps are taken to bring _____ the cost of living.
(a) up (b) over (c) on (d) down
- Q.21.** I am satisfied _____ innocence.
(a) at (b) with (c) for (d) of
- Q.22.** The manager wanted to meet you _____ the theft in the office.
(a) referring to (b) with regard to (c) with reference to (d) in connection with
- Q.23.** I absolutely refuse to put _____ with that sort of conduct.
(a) up (b) on (c) off (d) out
- Q.24.** We will have to atone _____ our misdeeds.
(a) at (b) on (c) for (d) with
- Q.25.** The climate is not conducive _____ good health.
(a) with (b) from (c) in (d) to
- Q.26.** Many things have happened _____ I met you last.
(a) before (b) when (c) from (d) since
- Q.27.** I always fall _____ old friends in times of need.
(a) over (b) through (c) back on (d) off

- Q.28.** The manager needs to hold _____ his anger.
(a) on (b) with (c) down (d) back
- Q.29.** The girl was very pleased _____ herself.
(a) in (b) on (c) over (d) with
- Q.30.** Desire _____ self-expression is one of the basic qualities of man.
(a) for (b) on (c) by (d) over
- Q.31.** The farmers suffered because the monsoon did not arrive _____ time.
(a) at (b) on (c) by (d) after
- Q.32.** The bride settled _____ very well in the new environment.
(a) on (b) down (c) up (d) off
- Q.33.** Are you really desirous _____ visiting Japan ?
(a) of (b) in (c) to (d) about
- Q.34.** The food that an average Indian eats has been found to be deficient _____ vitamins and proteins.
(a) of (b) from (c) with (d) in
- Q.35.** The tribes lived _____ customs different from anything the English had ever seen.
(a) on (b) by (c) off (d) with
- Q.36.** When he got married he _____ a life insurance policy.
(a) took up (b) took out (c) took in (d) took over
- Q.37.** The child did not approve _____ the father's plan.
(a) to (b) by (c) of (d) with
- Q.38.** We warned her _____ the danger.
(a) from (b) about (c) against (d) of
- Q.39.** We all laughed _____ the affair.
(a) over (b) about (c) for (d) on
- Q.40.** The streets are lighted _____ electricity.
(a) with (b) by (c) on (d) in
- Q.41.** Homoeopathic treatment, they say, cuts _____ the need for operation and risk from surgery.
(a) off (b) out (c) down (d) away
- Q.42.** He went _____ sea alone.
(a) in (b) to (c) into (d) on
- Q.43.** Everyone in this world is accountable to God _____ his actions.
(a) about (b) for (c) to (d) over
- Q.44.** A wise man profits _____ the mistakes of others.
(a) through (b) from (c) with (d) by
- Q.45.** Speed is _____ the essence.
(a) in (b) for (c) about (d) of
- Q.46.** He did not qualify _____ the job.
(a) for (b) to (c) against (d) with
- Q.47.** _____ the last ten years we have been victims of abuse.
(a) From (b) For (c) Before (d) Since
- Q.48.** The strike has been called _____.
(a) of (b) at (c) off (d) up

Q.49. He is always angry _____ children.

- (a) with (b) on (c) over (d) at

Q.50. The chairperson brushed _____ my suggestion.

- (a) out (b) over (c) aside (d) about

Q.51. He travelled all _____ the world when he was eighty years old.

- (a) in (b) over (c) with (d) of

Q.52. Dr. Sharma concluded his Speech _____ stressing on Buddha's teachings of the importance of charity.

- (a) by (b) with (c) at (d) in

Q.53. Shivaji Maharaj fought _____ every kind of aggression.

- (a) against (b) to (c) with (d) at

Q.54. Don't depend _____ others; you must stand on your own feet.

- (a) through (b) on (c) to (d) for

Q.55. Our life promises a lot _____ pleasure and we must learn to enjoy it.

- (a) with (b) for (c) of (d) at

Q.56. There is something wonderful _____ him.

- (a) of (b) about (c) for (d) inside

Q.57. When will you hand _____ your assignment ?

- (a) in (b) back (c) down (d) into

Q.58. _____ you leave now, you will be late.

- (a) Until (b) Till (c) Unless (d) Although

Q.59. _____ she is clever, she often makes mistakes.

- (a) Despite (b) Since (c) Although (d) Yet

Q.60. How did these things come _____?

- (a) about (b) into (c) at (d) down

Q.61. He knows French and German _____ Russian.

- (a) beside (b) besides (c) aside (d) except

Q.62. The Prime Minister of England called _____ the President of America.

- (a) in (b) out (c) on (d) at

Q.63. He drove from Maharashtra _____ Karnataka without stopping to rest.

- (a) Is (b) to (c) into (d) towards

Q.64. I have brought you some books _____ you to examine.

- (a) to (b) for (c) with (d) over

Q.65. We have talked a lot; now let us _____ to work.

- (a) get down (b) set off (c) take off (d) sit up

Q.66. Today students should be reconciled _____ the way things are changing.

- (a) with (b) to (c) for (d) at

Q.67. Did the boys turn _____ for football practice ?

- (a) up (b) on (c) back (d) in

Q.68. The fireman managed to put _____ the fire.

- (a) away (b) down (c) out (d) off

Q.69. The pupil was asked to write _____ his name on the front page of the exercise book.

- (a) back (b) in (c) down (d) about

Q.70. The teacher found many mistakes in my composition, when she went _____ it.

- (a) into (b) about (c) for (d) through

Q.71. The sparrows took no _____ the bread.

- (a) notice of (b) notice about (c) notice from (d) notice to

Q.72. He shows great ability _____ Mathematics.

- (a) at (b) for (c) about (d) in

Q.73. She has been supporting her family _____ her husband's death.

- (a) on (b) at (c) from (d) since

Q.74. The telephone kept _____ ringing, but no one attended.

- (a) off (b) on (c) up (d) up with

Q.75. She is sad because her father turned _____ her request.

- (a) up (b) off (c) out (d) down

Q.76. You should not confide _____ stranger.

- (a) in (b) to (c) with (d) by

Q.77. Poets have compared this world _____ a stage.

- (a) with (b) to (c) by (d) on

Q.78. I prevailed _____ him to contest the election.

- (a) on (b) off (c) over (d) of

Q.79. The headmaster congratulated Rajan _____ getting the merit scholarship.

- (a) for (b) about (c) with (d) on

Q.80. Smallpox has been eradicated _____ India.

- (a) in (b) about (c) within (d) out of

Q.81. Sachin was standing _____ me.

- (a) aside (b) next (c) beside (d) besides

Q.82. For a child, a blow _____ esteem is a terrible thing.

- (a) of (b) with (c) to (d) on

Q.83. The Principal called _____ an explanation from the clerks.

- (a) on (b) out (c) for (d) in

Q.84. It is our duty to get _____ the truth.

- (a) to (b) over (c) into (d) at

Q.85. A thorough search of the aircraft was carried _____ in the airport.

- (a) out (b) off (c) on (d) alone

Q.86. Discrimination _____ any form should be avoided.

- (a) of (b) by (c) from (d) in

Q.87. My friend's father died _____ cancer.

- (a) by (b) of (c) from (d) with

Q.88. His manners _____ him.

- (a) speak of (b) speak out (c) speak up (d) speak for

Q.89. The aim of education is to _____ the best in students.

- (a) bring on (b) bring in (c) bring about (d) bring out

Q.90. I have known him _____ a long time.

- (a) since (b) for (c) before (d) from

Q.91. He drained what was left _____ his drink.

(a) from (b) in (c) of (d) off

Q.92. Our teacher _____ points before the exams.

(a) cleared off (b) cleared away (c) cleared up (d) cleared out

Q.93. The cart was driven _____ bullocks.

(a) with (b) off (c) to (d) by

Q.94. The old gentleman _____ to be a very good friend of my grandfather.

(a) turned in (b) turned over (c) turned out (d) turned up

Q.95. The Chairman is ill and we'll have to _____ the meeting for a few days.

(a) put on (b) put of (c) put away (d) put off

Q.96. He is very good _____ making stories.

(a) in (b) about (c) at (d) for

Q.97. The monitor takes care _____ the class _____ the absence of the teacher.

(a) in; at (b) of; in (c) during; in (d) of; for

Q.98. When he saw the fish swimming _____ the river, he was extremely happy.

(a) on (b) besides (c) in (d) at

Q.99. Books are a great source _____ happiness.

(a) of (b) for (c) into (d) with

Q.100. He spoke _____ his travels.

(a) of (b) on (c) about (d) along

Q.101. Why do we always have to submit _____ his authority ?

(a) under (b) with (c) for (d) to

Q.102. The master assured her _____ success in the examination.

(a) of (b) in (c) for (d) with

Q.103. My windows look _____ garden.

(a) upon (b) out (c) on (d) at

Q.104. The reward was not commensurate _____ work done by us.

(a) for (b) on (c) with (d) upon

Q.105. I don't care _____ the expense. I want the party to be a real success.

(a) of (b) with (c) about (d) at

Q.106. Vinay does not play cricket, and _____ does Yeshwant.

(a) so (b) also (c) either (d) neither

Q.107. They live _____ the fifth floor.

(a) in (b) to (c) on (d) at

Q.108. My cousin will arrive _____ Sunday.

(a) in (b) at (c) the (d) on

Q.109. The boys went inside _____ room.

(a) of the (b) the (c) to the (d) of

Q.110. My younger brother is good _____ Mathematics.

(a) at (b) into (c) on (d) with

Answers With Explanation :-**Spot the Error**

- Sol.1.(a)** Replace "like" with "as". The preposition "as" is used to show that a person is in the role of somebody.
- Sol.2.(a)** Replace "of" with "from". "Tired from" is used to show physical fatigue due to an activity.
- Sol.3.(d)** no error.
- Sol.4.(a)** Replace "with" with "to". The preposition "to" is used to agree to the terms of a proposal.
- Sol.5.(b)** Replace "with" with "from". Differ from is used to show the comparison between one thing to another in terms of characteristics.
- Sol.6.(b)** Replace "from" with "for". "For" should be used.
- Sol.7.(a)** Replace "of" with "off". Here, "got off" is used to show the exit from the train.
- Sol.8.(d)** no error.
- Sol.9.(a)** Replace "but" with "but for". "But for" means "without".
- Sol.10.(b)** Replace "as" with "like". "Like" should be used for resemblance or similarity.
- Sol.11.(d)** no error.
- Sol.12.(c)** Replace "for" with "in". The preposition "in" should be used to indicate a time in the future.
- Sol.13.(b)** No error. 'But for' means without.
- Sol.14.(d)** no error.
- Sol.15.(a)** Add "to" after "walked". 'To' is used to show the destination.
- Sol.16.(c)** Replace "from" with "with". The preposition "with" is used to indicate "by using".
- Sol.17.(c)** Replace "from" with "with". "Part company with" means to end an association.
- Sol.18.(b)** Replace "to" after "traveling". 'To' is used to show the destination.
- Sol.19.(d)** no error.
- Sol.20.(b)** Replace "to" with "in". "In" is used with the adjective 'interested'.
- Sol.21.(a)** No error.
- Sol.22.(d)** no error.
- Sol.23.(b)** no error.
- Sol.24.(a)** Replace "to" with "with". "Differ with" is used in case of opinions.
- Sol.25.(b)** Replace "as" with "like". Here, "like" is used to represent the meaning of "for example".
- Sol.26.(a)** Replace "through" with "across". 'Across' means from one end to the other.
- Sol.27.(a)** Replace "to" with "for". "Taste for" is used for liking or preference.
- Sol.28.(d)** no error.
- Sol.29.(b)** Replace "to" with "on". Agree to is used for any proposal or request while agree on is used for any point.

Sol.30.(a) Replace "with" with "from". "Part with" is used to show separation from wealth whereas for relation "part from" is used.

Sol.31.(c) Replace "for" with "against". "Guard against" is used for protection.

Sol.32.(b) Replace "of" with "from". When the original material can't be taken back, "made from" is used.

Sol.33.(d) no error.

Sol.34.(b) Replace "for" with "with". "Part with" is used to show separation from wealth.

Sol.35.(c) Replace "for" with "from". 'From' is used after the verb 'prevent'.

Sol.36.(a) Replace "on" with "by". "Live by" means to follow a set of beliefs.

Sol.37.(d) no error.

Sol.38.(b) Replace "to" with "in". "Absorbed in" means to get completely lost in an activity.

Sol.39.(b) Replace "to" with "with". "Compare with" is used for comparison of the same things.

Sol.40.(a) Replace "on" with "for". "Live for" is used with fame.

Sol.41.(b) Replace "in" with "with". 'With' gives the meaning 'having something'.

Sol.42.(b) Replace "with" with "on". "Differ on" is used to show differences in points.

Sol.43.(b) Replace "in" with "with". "Soaked with" is used when something is saturated with a liquid.

Sol.44.(d) no error.

Sol.45.(b) Replace "in" with "of". "Partake of" means to eat or drink.

Sol.46.(b) no error.

Sol.47.(a) Replace "with" with "on". "Live on" means to depend on something for sustenance.

Sol.48.(b) Replace "of" with "from". When the original material can't be taken back, "made from" is used.

Sol.49.(b) Replace "to" with "with". The verb "amused" takes the preposition "at/by/with".

Sol.50.(b) Replace "for" with "in". "Partake in" means to participate.

Sol.51.(b) Replace "to" with "with". For a person "annoyed with" is used.

Sol.52.(d) no error.

Sol.53.(d) no error.

Sol.54.(b) Replace "for" with "of". The preposition "of" is used with the verb "capable".

Sol.55.(a) Replace "form" with "of". "Tired of" means bored or annoyed with something.

Sol.56.(b) Replace "of" with "for". The preposition "for" is used with the noun "capacity" to show someone's ability.

Sol.57.(b) Replace "for" with "to". "Chance to" means an opportunity to do something.

Sol.58.(d) no error.

Sol.59.(b) Replace "for" with "with". "Agree with" is used for persons.

Sol.60.(b) Replace "for" with "to". "Accommodate to" is used for a situation where "accommodate with" is used for a thing.

Sol.61.(d) no error.

Sol.62.(b) Replace "in" with "out". "Deal out" means to distribute.

Sol.63.(d) no error.

Sol.64.(c) Replace "with" with "to". "Compare with" is used for the comparison between same things while for different things "compare to" is used.

Sol.65.(b) Replace "to" with "in". "Blind to" means to be ignorant while "blind in" refers to blindness in one eye.

Sol.66.(d) no error.

Sol.67.(c) Replace "from" with "of". "Made of" is used when the original material can be taken back.

Sol.68.(b) Replace "with" with "on". "Decide on" is used for a course of action.

Sol.69.(a) Replace "in" with "to". "Blind to" means to be ignorant.

Sol.70.(d) no error.

Fill in the Blanks.

Sol.1.(a) Muse over someone or something. to reflect or meditate on someone or something.

Sol.2.(b) Catch up -succeed in reaching a person who is ahead of one.

Catch on -become popular

Sol.3.(a) Avail always takes the preposition of.

Sol.4.(a) hold something tightly or carefully so that you do not drop it or do not fall hold on tight

Sol.5.(a) Bring about- to make something happen, especially to cause changes in a situation.

Sol.6.(a) stood in the crowd

Sol.7.(b) indifferent (Adjective) : uninterested It agrees with Prep.-toHere, to is the right usage.

Sol.8.(d) Preposition "to" should be used with 'accession'

Sol.9.(d) indignant-angry and surprised

Sol.10.(b) "In work" means in job or employment.

Sol.11.(b) "And" should be used.

Sol.12.(c) Go down - be recorded or remembered in a particular way.

Sol.13.(b) The verb reconcile is followed by the preposition to .Reconcile to means to cause (a person) to accept something difficult or disagreeable.

Sol.14.(b) put off something/someone definition: to delay or move an activity to a later time, or to stop or prevent someone from doing something: .

Sol.15.(b) Preposition "from" should be used with "recover"

Sol.16.(b) discussed.Discuss about is redundant. But if you want to use the word about, you can have a conversation about, confer about, debate about.

Sol.17.(b) put off something/someone definition: to delay or move an activity to a later time, or to stop or prevent someone from doing something:

Sol.18.(d) Compliment -a polite expression of praise or admiration.

Sol.19.(a) Preposition "to" should be used with cater. Cater to - provide with what is needed or required.

Sol.20.(d) When people or events bring down a government or ruler, they cause the government or ruler to lose power.

Sol.21.(b) Preposition "with" should be used with satisfy

Sol.22.(a) referring to-mention or allude to.

(b) with regard to-consider or think of in a specified way.

(c) with reference to -about or concerning (something or someone) : in relation to

Sol.23.(a) put up- to tolerate, suffer through, or allow, especially something annoying

Sol.24.(c) atone for- to make up

Sol.25.(d) conducive to - making a certain situation or outcome likely or possible.

Sol.26.(d) Since should be used in Present/Past Perfect Tense. Since is used when the beginning of the action is mentioned. For is used for the "total time".

Sol.27.(c) Fall back on means- have recourse to when in difficulty.

Sol.28.(d) Hold back -stop doing something; cease or abstain.

Sol.29.(d) Preposition " with" should be used with "pleased"

Sol.30.(a) Preposition "for" should be used with "desire"

Sol.31.(b) On time means at a particular designated time. In this sentence, on time should be used with "arrive"

Sol.32.(b) settle down-to adopt an orderly and routine way of life, take up a permanent post, etc, esp after marriage

Sol.33.(a) desirous of - If you are desirous of doing something you want to do it very much or want it very much.

Sol.34.(d) Preposition "in" should be used with "deficient"

Sol.35.(b) live by- to agree with and follow

Sol.36.(c) Took in should be used.

Sol.37.(c) Approve of - To consider someone or something right,

Sol.38.(d) Warn of - to advise someone that something bad is likely to happen

Sol.39.(b) laugh about (something). To chuckle or giggle about something;

Sol.40.(a) "lighted with" electricity should be used.

Sol.41.(c) "cut down"- to reduce or curtail volume or activity .Example: Cut down on smoking

Sol.42.(b) "went to" should be used. Went to means -visited.

Sol.43.(b) "for his action"- should be used.

Sol.44.(b) Profit from something- to get an advantage from a situation.

Sol.45.(d) Speed is of the essence- it is very important to do something quickly

Sol.46.(a) Preposition "for" should be used.

Sol.47.(b) Total time is given, "for" should be used in Present/Past Perfect Tense.

Sol.48.(c) Call off - to cancel or abandon/ decide that something will not happen

Sol.49.(a) "angry with someone;angry at something". In this sentence, angry with children should be used.

Sol.50.(c) brush aside- to treat (something) as not important : to ignore or dismiss (something)

Sol.51.(b) "travelled all over" should be used.

Sol.52.(a) Preposition "by" should be used. Conclude something by doing something

Sol.53.(a) Preposition "against" should be used with "fought"

Sol.54.(b) Preposition 'on' is used with the verb 'depend'.

Sol.55.(c) "a lot of" should be used. A lot of -a large number or amount'.

Sol.56.(b) "wonderful about him" should be used.

Sol.57.(a) If you hand in something such as homework or something that you have found, you give it to a teacher,

Sol.58.(c) Unless should be used for condition. Until is used for time, while unless is used for condition.

Sol.59.(c) Although should be used. Although and though both mean 'in spite of something'.

Sol.60.(a) Come about- To happen or materialize.

Sol.61.(b) besides- in addition to; apart from

Sol.62.(c) Call on - pay a visit to (someone).

Sol.63.(b) "From destination A to destination B" "To" should be used.

Sol.64.(b) books for you should be the correct option.

Sol.65.(a) Let us get down to work - to start working You need to get down to work if you want to finish the assignment on time.

Sol.66.(b) reconcile means to cause (a person) to accept something difficult or disagreeable.

Sol.67.(a) Turn up means -appear

Sol.68.(c) Put out- to stop a fire from burning Firefighters put the fire out. Firefighters put out the fire.

Sol.69.(c) Write down - to note

Sol.70.(d) "went through" should be used. Go through- Search through or examine methodically.

Sol.71.(a) "notice of" should be used.

Sol.72.(d) "Ability in mathematics" should be used.

Sol.73.(d) The beginning time is given and the sentence is in the perfect tense, so "since" should be used.

Sol.74.(b) "kept on ringing" should be used. Keep on -continue to do something.

Sol.75.(d) "turn down" - rejection or refusal.

Sol.76.(b) "confide to" should be used. "Confide to [someone]" means: To tell a secret or private matter to someone,

Sol.77.(a) Compare with" should be the correct option.

Sol.78.(d) Preposition "of" should be used with "prevail" .Prevail of -to get control or influence in a particular situation

Sol.79.(a) "For" indicates something the person being congratulated has done specifically such as winning a prize or making a grade.

Sol.80.(a) eradicated in should be used.

Sol.81.(c) "standing beside me" - beside- at the side of; next to.

Sol.82.(c) "blow to" should be used. A blow to - : to damage or destroy (something) with an explosion

Sol.83.(c) "Call for" should be used. Call for -publicly ask for or demand.

Sol.84.(a) get to the truth- get to something means to address or to tackle

Sol.85.(a) "Carry out" should be used. Carry out- to bring to a successful issue : complete, accomplish

Sol.86.(a) Preposition "of" should be used with "Discrimination"

Sol.87.(b) died of -'die of' refers to dying as the result of a disease,

Sol.88.(a) speak of - seem to prove something exists or is true.

Sol.89.(d) bring out should be used. Bring out means- break, disclose, discover, divulge, expose, get around, get out.

Sol.90.(b) "for a long time" should be used.

Sol.91.(c) left of -It means "with whatever strength or energy remains in the person"

Sol.92.(c) cleared up - To clear up a problem, misunderstanding, or mystery means to settle it or find a satisfactory explanation for it.

Sol.93.(d) Preposition "by" should be used with "driven"

Sol.94.(c) "turn out" should be used -Turn out-prove to be the case.

Sol.95.(d) put off should be used. Put off- cancel /postpone

Sol.96.(c) Preposition "at" should be used with "good"

Sol.97.(b) The correct sentence will be - "take care of the class in the absence of the teacher"

Sol.98.(c) "swimming in the river" should be used.

Sol.99.(a) "Preposition" of should be used with "source"

Sol.100.(c) "Speak about" should be used.

Sol.101.(d) "Submit to"- accept or yield to a superior force or to the authority or will of another person.

Sol.102.(a) "Assured of" should be used.

Sol.103.(a) look upon - look on as or consider

Sol.104.(c) commensurate with - corresponding in size or degree; in proportion.

Sol.105.(c) "don't care about" should be used.

Sol.106.(d) neither should be used. The given sentence has a negative sense. So, "neither" should be used.

Sol.107.(c) "Live on the first floor" should be used.

Sol.108.(d) "Arrive on" should be used.

Sol.109.(b) "inside the room" is the correct option.

Sol.110.(a) Preposition "at" should be used with good.